Carla Srebot

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of British Columbia	2021–2027 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, Universidad de San Andrés	2019
B.A. in Economics, Universidad del Pacífico	2018

Research fields

Primary Fields: Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics
Secondary Fields: Development Economics, Economics of Gender

References

Professor Raffaele Saggio
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
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Professor Claudio Ferraz
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
claudio.ferraz@ubc.ca

Professor Thomas Lemieux
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
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Professor Heather Sarsons
Booth School of Business
University of Chicago
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Research papers

Sorting into (In)formality: Job Offers and Worker Preferences (*Job Market Paper*) [link]

Informal employment remains widespread in developing economies. Understanding whether workers remain informal because formal job offers are scarce or because they prefer the terms of informal work is important for designing policies to reduce informality. I distinguish these explanations using labor inspections in Brazil that require employers to register informal workers, creating opportunities to formalize existing jobs. Within six months, new formal hires correspond to 78% of informal men and 68% of informal women detected by inspectors. Take-up varies across workplaces, with the gender gap reversing between male- and female-dominated industries. To explain this pattern, I develop and estimate a discrete-choice model showing that men and women respond similarly to wage premia but differ in how they value non-wage job attributes. A complementary survey experiment shows that most workers accept formalization when offered, particularly when take-home pay is preserved. Women's lower acceptance is consistent with a more valuable informal alternative, partly reflecting household constraints and preferences for job attributes associated with informal work. Combining inspection-based take-up with observed labor-market transitions, I estimate that 38% of informal men and 29% of informal women have an opportunity to formalize within six months, assuming comparable take-up outside inspections. These results suggest that limited formal job opportunities are the main barrier to formalization, while wages and job attributes shape workers' willingness to accept formal employment.

Labor Market Flexibility and Gender Heterogeneity in Labor Allocation
Revise and Resubmit, **Journal of Development Economics** [link]

Does greater flexibility create job opportunities and improve labor allocation? This paper examines how firms and workers respond to a labor market flexibility shock in a setting characterized by high regulation costs. Focusing on the Brazilian labor market, I leverage linked formal employer-employee data to analyze the impacts of the 2017 Labor Reform, a policy that removed constraints on flexible work schedules. I show that this policy change led to an increase in job opportunities and employment, especially in part-time positions. Notably, women experienced greater employment gains. At the state level, I observe that while the reform did not significantly impact unemployment rates, it contributed to reduce informality, which accounted for 40% of the workforce in 2016. Gender-specific analysis indicates that this effect is primarily driven by women transitioning from informal to formal employment within the private sector in the short run, followed by both women and men in the state-level economy in the medium run. These findings underscore the interaction between labor market flexibility and gender disparities, underscoring the potential of such reforms to reconfigure

employment allocation. The case of the Brazilian reform offers a more nuanced perspective when informality is considered.

Managers and the Cultural Transmission of Gender Norms (with Virginia Minni, Kieu-Trang Nguyen and Heather Sarsons) [link]
NBER Working Paper 34782, 2026.

This paper studies how managers' gender attitudes shape workplace practices and culture. Using data from a multinational firm operating in over 100 countries, we leverage cross-country manager rotations to identify the effects of male managers' gender attitudes on gender pay gaps within teams. Managers from countries with one standard deviation more progressive gender attitudes reduce the pay gap by 5 percentage points (18% of the baseline gap), half of which is driven by women being promoted. These effects are strongest in conservative countries. They persist even after managers rotate out, in part because they influence the practices and attitudes of local managers, including peers who interact with them but are not under the direct purview of foreign managers.

Research in progress

Coaching the Match: Experimental Evidence from Chatbot Assistance and AI Augmentation in Mozambique's Gig Economy (with Jorge Zavala)

Bargaining across the Public–Private Margin: Unions, Gender Gaps, and Economic Mobility

Assimilation Policy and Indigenous Political Institutions: Evidence from American Indian Constitutions (with Sara Benetti and Christian Maruthiah)

Pre-doctoral refereed publications

Systemic Financial Crises and Income Inequality in OECD Countries (with Puneet Arora and Alberto Chong). *Open Economies Review* (2024), 35.

Environmental Disasters and Mental Health: Evidence from Oil Spills in the Peruvian Amazon (with Alberto Chong). *Review of Development Economics* (2023), 27(2).

Can Regional Trade Agreements Negatively Impact Primary Schooling? (with Alberto Chong). *Open Economies Review* (2023), 34.

Investment Confidence and Regional Trade Agreements with The United States (with Alberto Chong). *International Economics* (2020), 163.

Honors, awards and fellowships

Stone Centre on Wealth and Economic Inequality Fellowship, UBC	2025 – 2027
Faculty of Arts Graduate Award, UBC	2025 – 2026
W. Erwin Diewert Graduate Prize in Applied Economics, UBC	2023
President's Academic Excellence Initiative PhD Award, UBC	2021 – 2026
Four Year Doctoral Fellowship (4YF), UBC	2021 – 2025
Tuition Fellowship for Graduate Studies, Universidad de San Andrés	2019
Distinction for Undergraduate Thesis (Top 4), Universidad del Pacífico	2018

Grants

Stone Centre on Wealth and Economic Inequality Research Grant, CA$12,000 2026
Sorting into (In)formality: Job Offers and Worker Preferences

Stone Centre on Wealth and Economic Inequality Research Grant, CA$15,000 2024
The Fall of Unions and the Rise of the Populist Radical Right (with Claudio Ferraz)

Centre for Innovative Data in Economics Research (CIDER) Grant, CA$9,600 2023
Property Rights, Ethnic Identity and Individualism on Native American Reservations (with Christian Maruthiah)

Seminars and conferences

2026: XI UDEP Workshop for Young Economists, IDB RES Applied Economics Seminar, World Bank LACGIL Webinar

2025: LACEA, Policy Research Workshop: Women and Jobs in Latin America and the Caribbean, RIDGE Labor Workshop, WELAC-RIDGE

Teaching experience

TA, University of British Columbia, Vancouver School of Economics 2022–2025
Undergraduate: Poverty and Inequality, Principles of Macroeconomics (Head TA), Data in Economics, Economics of the Environment, Sex & Gender in the Economy

TA, Universidad de San Andrés, Economics Department 2020
Graduate: Econometrics, Big Data
Undergraduate: Principles of Microeconomics, Econometrics

TA, Universidad del Pacífico, Economics Department 2017–2021
Undergraduate: Econometrics, Microeconomics I

Research experience

University of British Columbia, Vancouver School of Economics 2024–2025
Research Assistant, Professor Heather Sarsons

University of British Columbia, Vancouver School of Economics 2022–2023
Research Assistant, Professor Claudio Ferraz

Universidad de San Andrés, Economics Department 2020
Research Assistant, Professor Martín Rossi

Universidad del Pacífico, Research Center (CIUP) 2018–2019
Research Assistant, Professor Pablo Lavado

Universidad del Pacífico, Research Center (CIUP) 2017–2018
Research Assistant, Professor Diego Winkelried

Academic service

Referee: American Economic Review, Journal of Labor Economics
Representative: PhD Students, Vancouver School of Economics 2024–2025
Member: VSE Women in Economics, University of British Columbia 2022–2026
Mentor: EconThaki, for underrepresented economics PhD applicants 2022

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent)

Nationality

Citizenship: Argentina, Peru
Permanent Resident in Canada